Task 4 — Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Module 4 | 20 Marks

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Part B — Social Media Do's and Don'ts

The following checklist outlines responsible social media behaviour for college students. As future professionals, your digital presence shapes how employers, peers, and institutions perceive you. Use this guide to build a positive and safe online identity.

Do's

- ✔ Keep your profile picture and bio professional — employers and college staff may view your profiles.
- ✔ Think before you post — ask yourself if you would be comfortable with your professor or future employer seeing it.
- ✔ Use privacy settings to control who sees your personal content.
- ✔ Credit original creators when sharing others' work or ideas.
- ✔ Use social media to share academic achievements, projects, and helpful resources.

Don'ts

- ✘ Don't share personal information like your address, phone number, or financial details publicly.
- ✘ Don't post anything offensive, discriminatory, or hurtful — even as a joke.
- ✘ Don't engage with or share unverified news and rumours.
- ✘ Don't use social media to vent about college, professors, or classmates.
- ✘ Don't share login credentials or click links from unknown accounts, even in DMs.

Communication Scenario & Key Learnings

In 2023, a college student in India posted a casual complaint about a faculty member's teaching style on a public Instagram story. The post went viral in the college community, leading to a formal complaint being raised against the student. What began as a moment of frustration ended with academic consequences and a damaged relationship with the faculty.

This could have been avoided by either addressing the concern directly with the professor, or using the college's official feedback mechanism.

Key Lesson

Digital platforms amplify reach beyond what we expect. A 'close friends' story or a private venting post can always be screenshotted and shared. The lesson is simple: if you would not say it to someone's face or put it in a formal letter, do not post it online.